

Law for AI Safety

Mission

AI could erode democracy, destabilise the economy, be used to develop powerful weapons, facilitate large-scale cyberattacks, or even potentially result in a loss of human control over increasingly capable systems. The development and societal impact of AI systems are accelerating rapidly, yet the fields of **AI governance and AI Law needed to oversee these technologies remain in their infancy.**

The **time to build this capacity is now.** Increasing concentrations of power, capital, and technological capabilities in the hands of a small number of AI companies and states risk reducing the agency of individuals, civil society, and democratic institutions unless **effective counterweights are developed.**

We aim to **bring together legal professionals who are concerned about the risks posed by advanced AI systems** and interested in **using legal and administrative levers to address them.** Using these levers where they already exist, and researching and advocating for reform where they are outdated, will be critical to **preserving the agency and rights of individuals and civil society in the age of AI,** and to **empowering them to act.**



Our Board member, Didier Coeurnelle, introducing Law for AI Safety's mission at the 2nd International Conference on Large-Scale AI Risks.

We will do this via three key mechanisms:

- We will **survey and convene** people working at the intersection of law and AI, both online and through meetups, hackathons, and other events, to **identify promising opportunities for impact, barriers to litigation, and favourable jurisdictions**. We also aim to organise research projects and fellowships to develop knowledge and experts in this area. We also want to **strategically communicate relevant research** to increase the likelihood of it being put into practice.
- We seek to promote greater **transparency** in AI governance through initiatives such as **Freedom of Information requests** directed at selected Member States and European Union institutions. These are essential to promoting **accountability and democratic oversight** in AI governance.
- Finally, we aim to advance **dialogue with the European Union, the Council of Europe, and other key stakeholders** through conferences, events, and targeted engagement.

We believe that **strategic legal and administrative pressure on EU institutions and Member States**, combined with effective **public communication**, can strengthen AI governance in Europe and contribute to **higher international standards** through the Brussels effect. In doing so, Europe can also play a leading role in building a broader **middle-power coalition** for AI safety.

The expertise, institutions, and networks built today will help determine whether increasingly powerful **AI systems remain accountable to democratic societies and the rule of law**.

Background

We have so far secured a small donation to cover some initial costs. We have set up our Google Workspace and Slack, and are working with a graphic designer on our logo and visual identity, as well as with a web developer on our website. We are currently developing onboarding processes and online spaces for individuals interested in joining our network. We have secured pro bono support from the global law firm Dentons,



which is helping us register in Brussels and has expressed interest in future collaboration.

We have **drafted an initial Freedom of Information (FOI)** request related to the advanced risks of AI, aimed at Member States, and are currently **finalising it following review by the [Future of Life Institute](#) team**. The FOI requests will be submitted in a number of Member States, and we plan to report on the outcomes. We also intend to draft FOI requests and petitions aimed at European Union institutions. We have also conducted some preliminary research into other **potential legal and administrative levers, as well as barriers to action**. Once funding is secured, we plan to conduct more in-depth research in this area. We also plan to make this research more widely known and accessible through in-person workshops, online webinars, YouTube videos and briefs to advocacy organisations.

We have begun building our **network**. We have established a relationship with [PauseAI](#) and are working with them to update their onboarding process so that **volunteers with legal backgrounds can be directed to us**. Through attending conferences, we have received strategic advice on the development of our organisation and connected with several experts in the field, including individuals involved with the EU AI Office and AI policy organisations, who have expressed a willingness to stay in touch and be informed about future opportunities for collaboration.

Our team first met at the "*Beyond the AI Act: Global Security & the Control Problem*" conference at the European Parliament, hosted by PauseAI and MEP Ondřej Kolář. Several members of our team were involved in organising the event. We would like to **organise a similar event at the Council of Europe**, this time with a stronger media presence. We have already **established contact with an individual there who is enthusiastic about the idea**, and we plan on taking the next steps once we are formally registered as an NGO.

On June 25, three members of our team — Raphaël Weuts, Karolina Gruzel, and Cristian Teodorescu — participated in the **"AI Act in Romania: From Regulation to Implementation"** conference at the European Parliament in Brussels. The event was hosted by **Maria Grapini**, Vice-Chair of the Committee on the Internal Market and Consumer Protection, and attended by, among others, **Victor Negrescu**, Vice-President of the European Parliament; **Brando Benifei**, former co-rapporteur on the EU AI Act; **Martin Ulbrich**, AI Policy Officer at the European Commission; and representatives of Romanian industry.





The contributions of our team emphasised the importance of **implementation of AI literacy**, the need for Europe to **strengthen its compute capacity if it is to have leverage in pushing internationally for rules ensuring AI safety**, and the fact that **large-scale AI risks also pose serious threats to businesses**. Our team also underlined that stakeholders across sectors should encourage leaders to prioritise a **global treaty on AI**.

We are currently working on grant applications to secure funding for organisational development, including research fellowships, legal hackathons, in-person meetups, and other field-building activities.

Founding Team

1. **Raphaël Weuts (Board Member)**. AI governance consultant. Author of *On Accuracy of European AI Law*. European representative in the Asia-Europe for AI Network AI Governance working group. Former visiting professor in AI at UC Leuven.
2. **Karolina Gruzel (Board Member)**. Educational background in European Law. Field-builder, Moral Ambition for AI. AI Policy Strategy Fellow, Successif. AI Policy and Research Communicator.
3. **Katie Stewart (Board Member)**. Senior research manager and financial sector specialist. Former ops at the Future of Humanity Institute and research and project manager at RAND.

4. **Didier Coeurnelle (Board Member)**. Lawyer. Co-chair of Healthy Life Extension Society. Board member for International Longevity Alliance. Advisor of Democracy Without Borders. Steering Committee member at the Global AI Governance Alliance.
5. **Raluca Spataru**, Practising lawyer. President of the Romanian chapter of PauseAI.
6. **Cristian Teodorescu**. Educational background in Human Rights Law. Managing Director at Neo Teo. Former senior expert for the Romanian Government.
7. **Julia Moncmanova**. Consulting creative designer at AppTweak.